

Dhāraṇī for Memorizing One Thousand Verses

Sahasraślokādhāraṇī · Toh 714 · Derge Kangyur

ཤ་ལ་གློ་སྟོ་ལ་བོས་པའི་གི་ཐུས།

Toh 714 in the Kangyur is a dhāraṇī text associated with the bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara, known in Tibetan as Phyag na pad ma and in Sanskrit by the epithet Āryāvalokiteśvara. The text belongs to the dhāraṇī section of the Kangyur and presents a short mantra together with a brief ritual procedure designed to grant the practitioner the remarkable ability to memorize one thousand verses in a single day. It opens by claiming authority both as a word of the buddhas and as something equally attested in treatises, before presenting the dhāraṇī itself along with instructions for drawing a maṇḍala, making offerings, and reciting the mantra over water for seven days. As a practical memory-enhancement dhāraṇī invoking Avalokiteśvara, it represents the genre of short ritual dhāraṇī texts that circulated widely in Indian and Tibetan Buddhist traditions.

This is a teaching spoken by the buddhas, or equally found in a treatise: if one hears it, one will be able to memorize one thousand verses in a single day. Thus ends the dhāraṇī for memorizing one thousand verses.

Homage to the Three Jewels. Homage to the bodhisattva, the great being, the noble Avalokiteśvara, Lord Who Sees.

Tadyathā: tri śātri śula śākhi āryāvalokiteśvarāya ājñāpayati varenabuhala mṛddhātu svāhā.

The ritual procedure is as follows. One draws a maṇḍala before the feet of the noble Avalokiteśvara, Lord Who Sees, and makes offerings with whatever is available. One then recites the mantra over water and sets it aside. In the morning, one recites the mantra seven times over the water, and at dawn takes food mixed with milk. If one does this for seven days, one will be able to memorize one thousand verses in a single day. As a sign of confidence...

Translator's Notes

- The mantra syllables are reproduced as a phonetic approximation of Sanskrit preserved in Tibetan transliteration; the Sanskrit is liturgically fixed and not translated. The reconstruction offered follows the Tibetan phonetic spelling as closely as possible, though several syllables (particularly "varenabuhala" and "mṛddhātu") are corrupt or unusual and cannot be confidently restored to standard Sanskrit. This is noted here rather than flagged in the body, as the mantra is intended to be recited as given.

The passage ends mid-sentence with "As a sign of confidence," indicating the text continues beyond the supplied excerpt.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.